

GREY BANNER ALERT



Serious Incident – Preliminary Notice

CRITICAL RISK: Vehicles and Driving

Date of Incident	5 th May 2026	Time of Incident	3:40 PM
Directorate / Region	RMO – Kimberley	Main Roads or Contractor	Main Roads
isafe Event Type	Damage / Loss	isafe Incident Number	INC-0076
Actual Consequence	Moderate	Potential Consequence	Catastrophic
Reportable to WorkSafe	No	Type of Notifiable Incident	N/A

Incident Short Description	Vehicle rollover resulting in serious damage, no injuries reported
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Executive Summary

At approximately 3:40 PM, a Main Roads vehicle travelling along the Gibb–Kalumburu Road was returning from an inspection when the vehicle struck a washout located in the centre of the roadway, resulting in a rollover.

A second Main Roads vehicle travelling behind arrived shortly after the incident and assisted. The overturned vehicle was righted and secured, and both occupants were transferred into the second vehicle. Both driver and passenger reported no injuries, however the vehicle suffered major damage.

Due to the remote location and the time of day, the decision was made to proceed to the construction camp as the safest option. The workers arrived at approximately 8:50 PM.

Welfare checks were conducted throughout the night to monitor for delayed injury or illness, and no issues were identified.



Images of washout and overturned vehicle

Contributing Factors

- Road conditions were very poor due to wet season, and unsealed sections were closed to members of the public.
- The time of day was a contributing factor as shadows obscured the washout in the road, reducing visibility and making it difficult for the driver to identify in time.
- Insufficient journey planning was identified. An earlier return to camp may have reduced exposure to low-light conditions and shadows, improving visibility and the ability identify road hazards.
- The risk register control 'drive to conditions' does not clearly define the required driving behaviours for managing hazards such as washouts on remote, unsealed roads.

Corrective Actions

- Implement journey planning requirements that allow vehicles to return to base camp early in the afternoon, minimising exposure to reduce-visibility conditions. Ensure potential hazards are identified, communicated and understood by all personnel and visitors before and during the site travel activities.
- Implement a process to identify, mark, and where necessary, barricade potential washouts and other high-risk areas. Ensure hazard locations are regularly inspected, maintained and communicated to all site personnel and visitors to prevent vehicle incidents and injuries.
- Emergency response procedures to be reviewed and updated to identify the potential obstacles for emergency response for remote areas, particularly where roads are impassable.
- Region to review whether vehicles driving on remote and high-risk roads must travel in convoy.

Distribution of Notice

Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations